

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Sakthivel Kumar

Address: 42 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to object to the above planning proposal on the grounds that it conflicts with several key policies of the London Plan, specifically GG3, D14, T2, T4, and SL1. These policies aim to ensure that development protects residential amenity, promotes healthy and safe streets, and avoids harmful environmental and transport impacts.

The proposal, in its current form, fails to meet these requirements for the reasons set out below.

1. Policy GG3 - Creating a Healthy City

Policy GG3 requires developments to protect the health, wellbeing, and quality of life of existing communities by reducing noise, pollution, overcrowding and preventing harm to residential amenity.

Contravention:

The development will bring large volumes of people into a quiet residential area, especially during peak events such as Friday prayers where the council notes that up to 250 attendees may leave the site late in the evening (up to 11pm), causing significant disturbance to neighbouring homes. Such late evening footfall and vehicle activity will harm peace, wellbeing, and sense of safety for nearby residents, contrary to GG3's expectations for safe, inclusive, low disturbance neighbourhoods.

This directly undermines the policy intent of supporting healthy, peaceful communities.

2. Policy D14 - Noise and Vibration

Policy D14 requires all new developments to:

Avoid generating unacceptable noise

Protect existing residents from additional noise sources

Provide effective mitigation measures

Contravention:

The council's preapplication feedback already raised concerns that vehicle movements, people arriving and departing, and the operation of the site until 11pm will create significant noise and disturbance within a predominantly residential setting.

The scale of activity-especially with a maximum capacity of 250 people-presents a clear risk of unacceptable noise exposure to surrounding homes, including those with gardens immediately adjacent to the site.

No meaningful noise mitigation strategy has been presented that could realistically offset this level of disturbance.

The proposal therefore fails to comply with D14's requirement to protect residents from harmful noise impacts.

3. Policy T2 - Healthy Streets

Policy T2 seeks to ensure streets are safe, pedestrianfriendly, and not dominated by vehicles.

Developments must avoid worsening conditions for people walking, cycling, or living in residential streets.

Contravention:

Dorset Road, Balmoral Way, and surrounding residential streets are narrow, heavily parked, and not designed for surges of traffic or parking demand.

The anticipated influx of cars during peak times will create unsafe conditions for pedestrians, including children walking to and from nearby residential properties.

Increased turning movements at the site's vehicular access further undermines street safety.

The proposal conflicts with T2 because it makes local streets less safe and less accessible.

4. Policy T4 - Assessing and Mitigating Transport Impacts

Policy T4 requires developments to:

Undertake a full assessment of transport impacts

Demonstrate no severe impact on congestion or road safety

Provide effective mitigation

Contravention:

The site has a PTAL rating of 1a, among the lowest possible, meaning almost all attendees would rely on private cars.

The council has stated that Friday prayers alone could generate demand for ~21 additional onstreet spaces even after using all onsite spaces-creating severe parking stress in an already constrained area.

This level of parking overspill and congestion represents a severe transport impact, failing the T4 policy test.

The development does not provide realistic mitigation capable of addressing these impacts.

As such, the proposal falls significantly short of T4 requirements.

5. Policy SL1 - Social Infrastructure

Policy SL1 supports community facilities only when they:

Are appropriately located

Do not negatively impact neighbours

Are accessible via sustainable modes

Provide benefits without harming amenity or safety

Contravention:

While community facilities are supported in principle, this site is not suitable due to its very poor transport accessibility and residential context.

The proposed intensity of use will negatively impact neighbouring homes, particularly through noise, traffic, nighttime activity, and parking overspill.

The location fails SL1's requirement for accessibility and for avoiding adverse impact on residential amenity.

Therefore, the proposal cannot be considered acceptable under SL1.

Conclusion

The development is fundamentally incompatible with key London Plan policies governing health, noise, transport, and residential amenity. It would introduce:

Excessive noise and disturbance

Severe parking and traffic pressures

Unsafe and unhealthy street conditions

Disproportionate impact on surrounding residential properties

For these reasons, and given clear conflicts with policies GG3, D14, T2, T4, and SL1, I respectfully request that the planning authority refuse this application.

Yours faithfully,
Sakthivel Kumar